

The following assumes you have some basic knowledge of C#.

Modifying Your Screensaver

Let's get started with a simple hack: changing the default images in the screensaver. In VCS's Start page, click on Create (or **File > New > Project**) and select the ScreenSaver starter kit. You'll see the project's documentation page, which tells you how to use the project, get to the screensaver's options and so on. We recommend giving this a good read—it also tells you which code file contains what and how the project itself is structured.

The first thing you need to do is add (or remove) images in the project's resources. In the Solution Explorer, expand Properties and double-click on Resources.resx to modify it. You'll see a table with DefaultRSSText—ignore this for now. On the top left, you'll find a button labelled Strings—click on the arrow next to it and select Images. This is where you can remove the two default images; use the Add Resource button and choose Add Existing File to add your own images.

Tip

To see all the files in your project's directory, use the Show All Files button in the Solution Explorer—it's the second one from the left



The graphical way to edit your project's resources. Resources.resx is actually just an XML file that points to the files—be they documents, icons or images

Now that you've changed the default images, you need to go change the code that calls it. Double-click on ScreenSaverForm.cs. You're first taken to a blank Windows form—just right-click on this and select View Code (you can do the same from the Solution Explorer itself, instead of bothering with this). Go to the definition of LoadDefaultBackgroundImages()—this is the function that is called if you haven't selected an image folder in the screensaver